

Mrs. Margaret T. LeDoux

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Here it was smiling down on the "Father of Waters", that five of us were privileged to breath our first morning air and "sing our first baby music". No doubt little Bernard must have been proficient in that music; because it was during his term of baby-hood that Papa went blind with the ague - when for two weeks he had to be led by the hand, and his little namesake got a rupture from which he never completely recovered. Like in all other trials, however, the Good God had His designs herein also, and we can say with fullest conviction and in all gratitude To-day: "The Lord knows best." May He be in all His plans eternally praised! How we must have thrived there in real unworldliness and Innocence! Dangers of course were not wanting, to keep dear Father and Mother "on edge" and often, no doubt in anxiety. Wild beasts and rattle-snakes seem to been the most common cause of such anxiety, though two of our little cousins were drowned together just below our little retreat, in the River - otherwise so generous, so noble, so majestic.

Trimbelle too!!! How removed! How primitive! How picturesque! How rich in its varity and abundance of wild flowers and fruits and nuts and berries!!! - with beautiful patches of grove to our west, illimitable forests off to the East (down on the "bottoms" and across the Willow River of that county. They call it the Trimbelle. To the South, were vallies and rolling prairies down to Diamond Bluff five miles below on the Mississippi - a fair pasture field for cattle as well as deer and other wild animals. But it was also a fair race-track for our most dreaded enemy the prairie-fire, that nearly every year would darken the sky in its crackling rush toward us through abundance of wild grass, prairie-tea, hazel and other brush. On such occasions "Lamb's Road", running east & west on ridge about 30 rods to our south nearly always proved a great protection. If the gale were not too strong our dear neighbors would have time to come to our rescue, as they often did by lining up along that road and preventing the the fire from crossing. It was just a private road to a twenty-acre field off to our S.E. from the Miller farm on our S.W. The public road, such as it was, ran just past our little log cabin - a one-story mansion about 12 x 30 feet. You may smile at this title I honor it with, especially when you learn that it had a single partition only below, "the bed-room" -- Father and Mother on the one side and the little girls, Ellie and Maryann and little Mattie on the other - and the loft above where little boys slept and in the morning sometimes played till they quarreled as little boys are wont to do. An ordinary man could walk straight down stairs, but there was one young J.B. Fahey - six foot two - who was careful not to bump his head on the cross-joices and, therefore, had to stoop a little.....The only door led in from the sunny end while a single window on each side let in the light.